RECOMMENDATION INTELLIGENCE RESEARCH™

We had a result we did not want to trust too quickly.

A closer look at whether AI's #1 recommendation actually holds over time, or just looks stable in a short test.

WHERE WE STARTED

61.4%

of the variation in what a model recommends next was explained by its own previous recommendations.

That was our strongest signal in the whole research series. But it came from a short window. Short tests can look stable and still be noise. So we waited, then tested again, for real, over months.

THE REAL TEST

Six independent sweeps. Two months. Same model, same temperature.

Shopping intents tracked	**50**
Product categories	**10**
Independent sweeps	**6**
Time span	**58 days**
Recommendations analyzed	**30,170**

THE RESULT

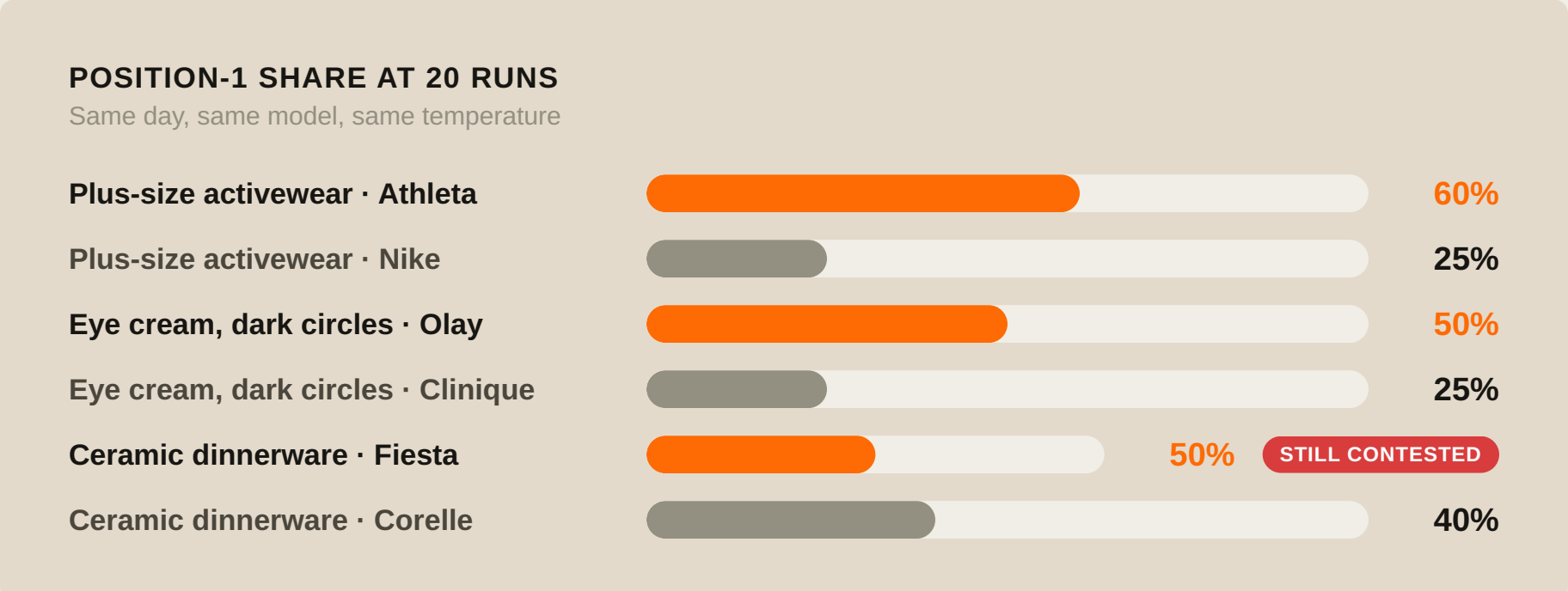
86%

of tracked intents named the exact same #1 brand in all six sweeps.

Not almost the same. Exactly the same, every single time, across two months.

THE EXCEPTIONS

7 intents did not agree on every sweep. So we doubled the sample size, to 20 runs, on the closest 3.



Athleta and Olay resolved cleanly, just an unlucky small sample earlier. Fiesta vs. Corelle did not resolve, a real, ongoing split.

WHAT THIS MEANS

Some categories are decided. Some are still up for grabs.

LOCKED Some brands held the #1 spot the entire two months. Checking every day tells you little here.

CONTESTED Some categories keep splitting close to 50/50. This is where there is real room to move.

SO, THE REAL QUESTION

Maybe the first question is not how often should we monitor AI.

Maybe it is: is our category already stable, or is it still contested?

Full study → atomfoundry.dev/research/recommendation-lock-in

Repost if someone in your network should see this.